15 Legit Ways to Make Money Without Investing Anything

Discover practical methods to earn money online without any financial investment.

Updated October 5, 2026

QUICK ANSWER

You can make money without investing by engaging in online surveys, freelancing, selling unused items, and participating in cashback programs. These methods require time and effort rather than upfront cash.



Making money without any investment may seem challenging, but there are numerous legitimate ways to do so. Whether you're looking to earn some extra cash on the side or seeking a full-time income, the following methods provide actionable steps to help you get started. Below are some of the most effective ways to earn money without any financial investment.

1. Online Surveys

One of the easiest ways to earn money is by participating in online surveys. Companies are willing to pay for consumer opinions to enhance their products and services.

Popular Survey Sites

- **Swagbucks**: Earn about $0.50 to $2.50 per survey.
- **Survey Junkie**: Pays around $1 to $3 per completed survey.
- **Vindale Research**: Offers $1 to $5 for various surveys.

Pros and Cons

- **Pros**: Flexible schedule and no investment required.
- **Cons**: Earnings can be low and surveys may take time to qualify for.

2. Freelancing

If you possess skills in writing, graphic design, or programming, freelancing can be a lucrative option.

Platforms to Consider

- **Upwork**: You can find projects in various fields. Average earnings range from $20 to $100+ per hour based on expertise.
- **Fiverr**: Start offering your services at $5 and increase your rates as you gain more clients.

Requirements

- A strong portfolio and good communication skills.
- Time investment to build your profile and acquire clients.

3. Selling Unused Items

Decluttering your home can also help you make money. You'd be surprised at how much your unused items can sell for.

Where to Sell

- **eBay**: You can sell anything from clothes to electronics.
- **Facebook Marketplace**: Easy to list items locally without shipping.
- **Poshmark**: Great for selling clothes and accessories.

Tips for Selling

- Take clear, high-quality photos.
- Write detailed, honest descriptions.

4. Cashback Apps

Using cashback apps allows you to earn money back on purchases you were already planning to make.

Recommended Apps

- **Rakuten (formerly Ebates)**: Offers 1% to 15% cash back at various retailers.
- **Ibotta**: Provides cash back on grocery purchases. Users can earn between $0.25 to $5 based on offers.

Pros and Cons

- **Pros**: Easy to use and no upfront costs.
- **Cons**: Cashback may take time to process and some offers have restrictions.

5. Affiliate Marketing

If you have a blog or social media presence, affiliate marketing can be a good way to earn money.

Getting Started

- Sign up for affiliate programs like **Amazon Associates** or **ShareASale**.
- Share links to products and earn a commission on sales.

Earnings Potential

- Commissions can range from 1% to 50% depending on the product and program.

6. Virtual Assistance

Many businesses are looking for virtual assistants to help with administrative tasks.

How to Start

- Join platforms like **Belay** or **Fancy Hands**.
- Tasks can include email management, scheduling, and more.

Earnings

- Average pay ranges from $15 to $30 per hour based on experience.

7. Pet Sitting or Dog Walking

If you love animals, consider offering pet sitting or dog walking services in your local area.

Where to Find Clients

- Use apps like **Rover** or **Wag!** to connect with pet owners.

Earnings

- Dog walkers can earn $15 to $30 per walk, and pet sitters can charge $25 to $50 per visit.

8. Tutoring or Teaching Online

If you have expertise in a subject, you can tutor students online.

Platforms to Use

- **VIPKid**: Teach English to children in China and earn $14 to $22 per hour.
- **Chegg Tutors**: Offers $20 per hour for tutoring in various subjects.

Pros and Cons

- **Pros**: Flexible hours and rewarding work.
- **Cons**: Requires teaching skills and may need a degree in some cases.

Method	Potential Earnings	Time Investment
Online Surveys	$0.50 - $5 per survey	Low
Freelancing	$20 - $100+ per hour	Moderate to High
Selling Unused Items	Varies widely	Low
Cashback Apps	1% - 15% cash back	Low
Affiliate Marketing	1% - 50% commission	Moderate
Virtual Assistance	$15 - $30 per hour	Moderate
Pet Sitting/Dog Walking	$15 - $50 per hour	Moderate
Tutoring/Teaching Online	$14 - $22 per hour	Moderate to High

By using these methods, you can start making money without any financial investment. The key is to be persistent and dedicated to your chosen approach for the best results.

Frequently Asked Questions

How much money can I realistically make using these methods?

Earnings can vary widely based on the method and effort involved. Some people make a few dollars a month, while others can earn hundreds.

Are there any hidden fees with these methods?

Most of these methods do not have hidden fees, but some platforms may take a small percentage of your earnings.

Do I need special skills to start freelancing or tutoring?

While some skills are helpful, many platforms allow beginners to start with basic tasks. However, specialized subjects may require expertise.

How long does it take to see results?

Results depend on the method. For instance, selling items can yield immediate cash, while freelancing may take time to build a client base.

Can I combine these methods for more income?

Absolutely! Many people successfully combine multiple methods to maximize their earnings.

Is it safe to use cashback apps?

Yes, reputable cashback apps like Rakuten and Ibotta are safe to use, but always read reviews and terms before signing up.

Do I need to pay taxes on money earned this way?

Yes, any money you earn is taxable, so keep track of your income for tax purposes.